Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-11-02

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Philemon 1:15-25

15 For perhaps he departed for a while for this purpose, that you might receive him forever,

16 no longer as a slave but more than a slave—a beloved brother, especially to me but how much more to you, both in the flesh and in the Lord.

17 If then you count me as a partner, receive him as you would me.

18 But if he has wronged you or owes anything, put that on my account.

19 I, Paul, am writing with my own hand. I will repay—not to mention to you that you owe me even your own self besides.

20 Yes, brother, let me have joy from you in the Lord; refresh my heart in the Lord.

21 Having confidence in your obedience, I write to you, knowing that you will do even more than I say.

22 But, meanwhile, also prepare a guest room for me, for I trust that through your prayers I shall be granted to you.

23 Epaphras, my fellow prisoner in Christ Jesus, greets you,

24 as do Mark, Aristarchus, Demas, Luke, my fellow laborers.

25 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit. Amen.

II. Key Summary

• Paul tells Philemon that this man perhaps departed for a while so that Philemon might receive him forever, no longer as a slave but as a beloved brother (vv. 15-16).

• Paul asks Philemon to receive him as he would receive Paul; if he has wronged Philemon or owes anything, it goes on Paul's account, and Paul writes "I will repay" with his

own hand (vv. 17-19).

• Paul is confident Philemon will obey and do even more than he says, asks him to prepare a guest room, and closes with greetings from Epaphras, Mark, Aristarchus, Demas, and Luke and a blessing of grace (vv. 21-25).

III. Passage Analysis

Departed for a While, Received Forever

> Philemon the master lost a slave; but Philemon the Christian gained a brother, and he gained that brother forever. [1]

Verse 15 sets "for a while" beside "forever," and verse 16 goes on to say "no longer as a slave but more than a slave." What Philemon receives is "a beloved brother."

Put That on My Account

> Paul is willing to take on Onesimus's debt. This is similar to Jesus Christ, who took the sin of all humanity upon himself. [2]

In verse 18 Paul says "put that on my account," and in verse 19 he writes "I will repay" with his own hand; the link to Jesus comes from the commentary. What the passage states plainly is that Paul himself will pay this debt.

IV. Reflection Question

If someone who wronged you or owes you came back to you, what would you do? If someone asked you to receive that person, what would you think?

Philemon was facing someone just like that (Onesimus, see v. 10). Paul says "receive him as you would me" and "put that on my account," and this man is "no longer as a slave" but "a beloved brother."

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Commentary on Philemon 1, https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/philemon-1/

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (華人基督徒查經資料網站), Shi Qingzhou (石清洲), Chinese Bible Commentary: Philemon, https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/New%20Testament/57Philem/57GT01.htm